終 曲
FINALE

for SATB choir and piano
(2025)

Duration: ca. 5’30

KAI-YOUNG CHAN

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Instagram: chankaiyoung.composer

TEXT AND TRANSLATION

《終曲》陳卓楓

如今最尾一曲 在這刻終獻上
仍不捨想要哭 亦要忍得勉強
如果不想結束 就把尾音盡量延長
害怕曲一終 人就散

回想 當天我一鼓衝動參與了合唱
不知 合唱的路是那麼漫長
和同伴一起雕琢 一首一首的樂章
再難唱的歌 都學懂唱

如今最尾一曲 在這刻終獻上
曾經艱苦努力 願會得你欣賞
如果不想結束 就把尾音盡量延長
害怕曲一終 人就散

還記得 指揮你苦心鼓勵 指引我路向
人生的旋律 像過山車升高再下沉
沿途開開心心吱吱喳喳的加速
忽爾悲傷放慢
仍然請你細心欣賞

如今最美一曲 在這刻終獻上
如孤單得要哭 別要苦苦勉強
同伴於你身邊 這先叫合唱
別怕曲一終 人就散

旅途上 世界的聲音我都在唱
琴弦嘹亮 讓我歌展翅飛翔
邂逅曇花般的彩虹 歌聲裏雪花飛揚
伴我抬頭面對星空 度過黑夜漫長
不過再美妙的樂章 都會完場

如今最美一曲 共你一起獻上
如開心得要哭 別怕哭出洋相
如果不想結束 相約下次一起再唱
合唱的生涯 把你我照亮

如今最愛的歌 讓我於此送上
多少歡欣跟眼淚 盡數跟你分享
如今終須結束 灑脫地唱 別延長
未怕曲一終 人就散
就算曲終 人未散
就算曲終 情未散

Carl Cheuk-Fung Chan: Finale

The final song is now offered,
Reluctant to end, holding back tears.
If you don't want it to stop, let the last note linger.
Fearing when the song ends, we'll part ways.

Recalling the impulse to join the choir,
Unaware the journey would be so long.
With companions, we crafted each melody,
Learning to sing even the toughest songs.

This final song, we present with pride,
Hoping you would appreciate our hard work.
If you don't want it to end, stretch the final note,
Dreading when the song fades, we'll be apart.

Remember the conductor's encouragement,
Guiding us through life's ups and downs.
Like a rollercoaster, the melody soars and dips,
Joyful chatter speeds up, then slows in sorrow—
please listen closely.

The most beautiful song is now sung,
If loneliness brings tears, don't force a smile.
With companions by your side, this is true harmony.
Don't fear when the song ends, we'll be apart.

On this journey, I sing the world's voices,
Strings resonate, letting my song take flight:
Encountering fleeting rainbows, swirling snowflakes,
Facing the starry sky, enduring the long night.
Even the finest music must end.

This beautiful song, we share together,
If joy brings tears, don't fear looking foolish.
If you don't want it to stop, let's sing again next time.
The choir's journey lights up our lives.

This beloved song, I offer now,
Sharing every joy and tear with you.
Though it must end, sing freely, don't linger—
Fear not when the song ends, we'll be apart.
Even when the song ends, we'll be together.
Even when the song ends, our bonds remain.

PERFORMANCE NOTES

Cantonese Rising Tones
The notation of a scoop is intended to reflect the rising tones in Cantonese (tones 2 and 5). All scoops are to be played on the beat, with a quick, soft glide leading to the note they are attached to. No accents should be added to these scoops, as suggested in some performance practices in the western repertoire.

Cantonese Diphthongs
Unless otherwise specified, for all diphthongs (gliding vowels), the latter vowel should arrive an eighth note before the end of the note. For those on an eighth note or notes of shorter values, the latter vowel should arrive at half the value of the note.

RESOURCES

Cantonese Contemporary Music Research
https://cantonesecomposition.com

Cantonese Creative Suite
https://app.cantonesecomposition.com

Cantonese Choral Database
https://bit.ly/canto-choral-database

Composer
https://chankaiyoung.com
Instagram: chankaiyoung.composer

PROGRAM NOTES

Finale is written for the Hong Kong Inter-school Choral Festival (HKICF) 2026. With an original text by local lyricist Carl Chan (an avid choral singer himself), the work seeks to animate the joy and sweat of singing together, as well as the bittersweet moments of delivering the last song as a choir. From the thrill of nailing a tough harmony to the quiet ache of coming to the end of a performance, this piece follows a choir's journey guided by a conductor's firm and steady hand through the ups and downs of life.

Paying homage to popular choral pieces that have echoed through Hong Kong's halls, the text invites reflections on the shared journey of music-making. It is a celebration of voices entwined, a reminder that even as the song fades, the heart's connections linger, steadfast and unbroken, through the resonances that follow.

《終曲》為2026年香港校際合唱節（HKICF）而作。歌詞由本地詞人陳卓楓所原創，生動描繪了加入合唱團一起歌唱的喜悅與汗水，以及合唱團在音樂會中獻上最後一首歌時，那份甜中帶苦的滋味。從成功演繹高難度和聲的興奮，到演出結束時那份靜默的悵惘，引人想像歌者跟隨合唱團在指揮堅定而穩健的引領下，走過人生的高低起伏。

《終曲》的歌詞亦致敬了多首曾在香港各大演出場地迴響過的經典合唱作品，期望讓曾經參與合唱的人在共同的旅程中尋找共鳴。此曲讚頌了交織的歌聲，亦提醒了我們：即使歌聲漸漸消逝，彼此的連繫仍能在心中餘韻縈迴不絕。

FOR MORE

"Constraints/Creativity: Cantonese Choral Works by Kai-Young Chan", the composer's portrait album, is available on major streaming platforms including Spotify, Apple Music, YouTube Amazon Music, Tidal, Deezer,

An anthology of study score of 12 Cantonese choral works by the composer is published as "Constraints/Creativity: Cantonese Choral Works"
on Universal Edition (2024).

Hong Kong Inter-School Choral Festival 2026 Commissioned Piece, commissioned by The Hong Kong Virtuoso Chorus

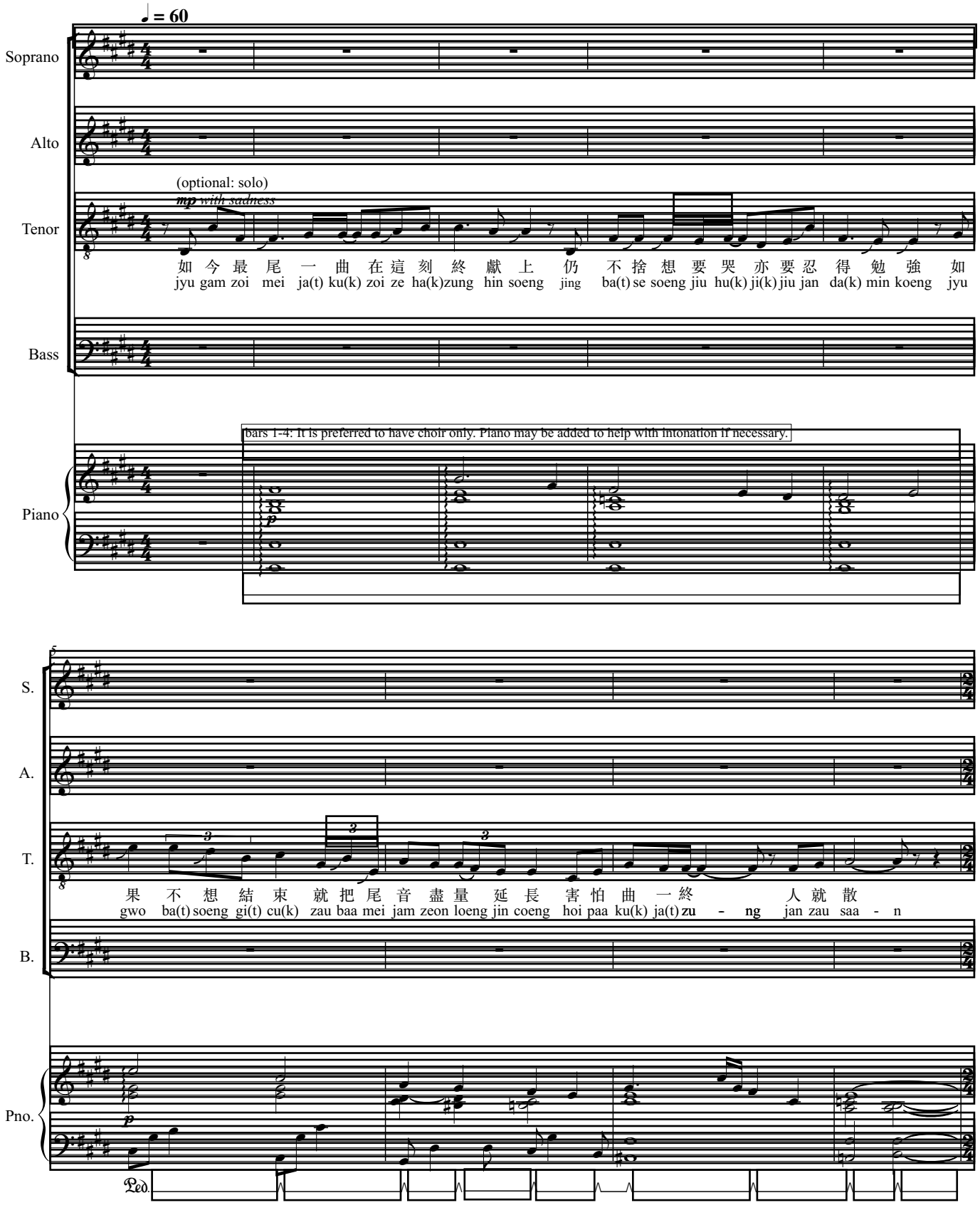
終曲

Finale
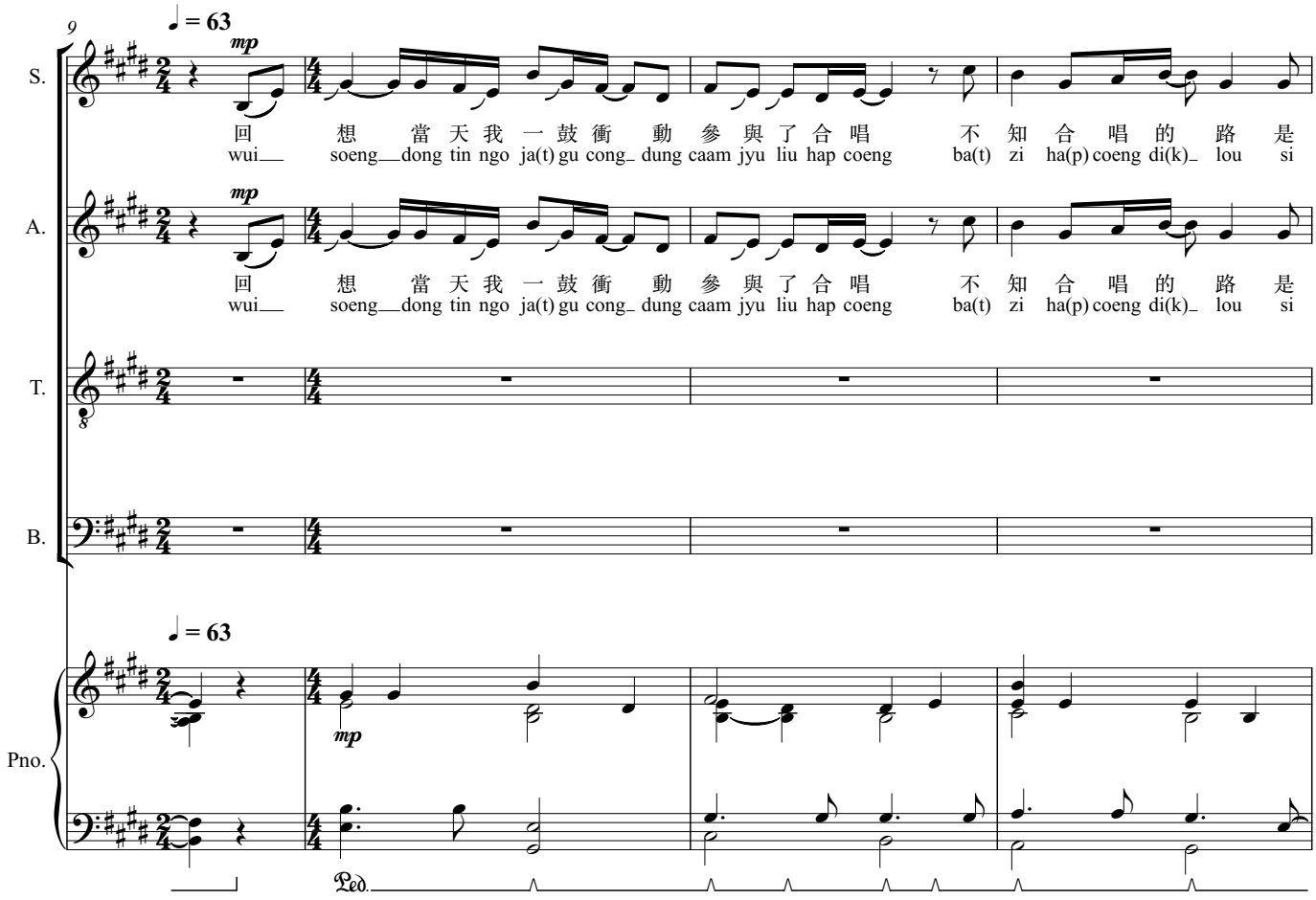
for SATB choir and piano (2025)
in Cantonese
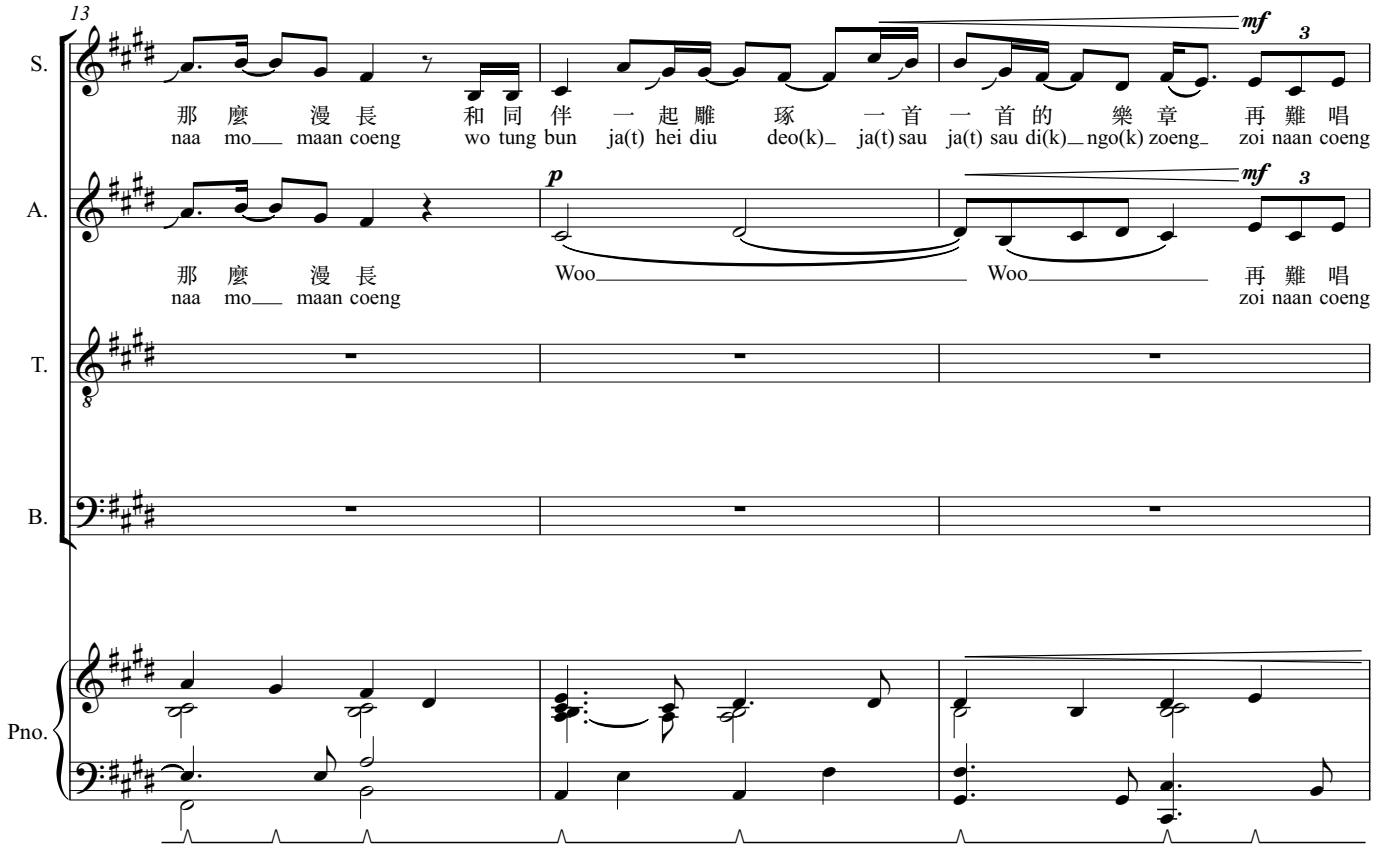
陳卓楓
Carl Cheuk-Fung Chan

陳啟揚
Kai-Young Chan
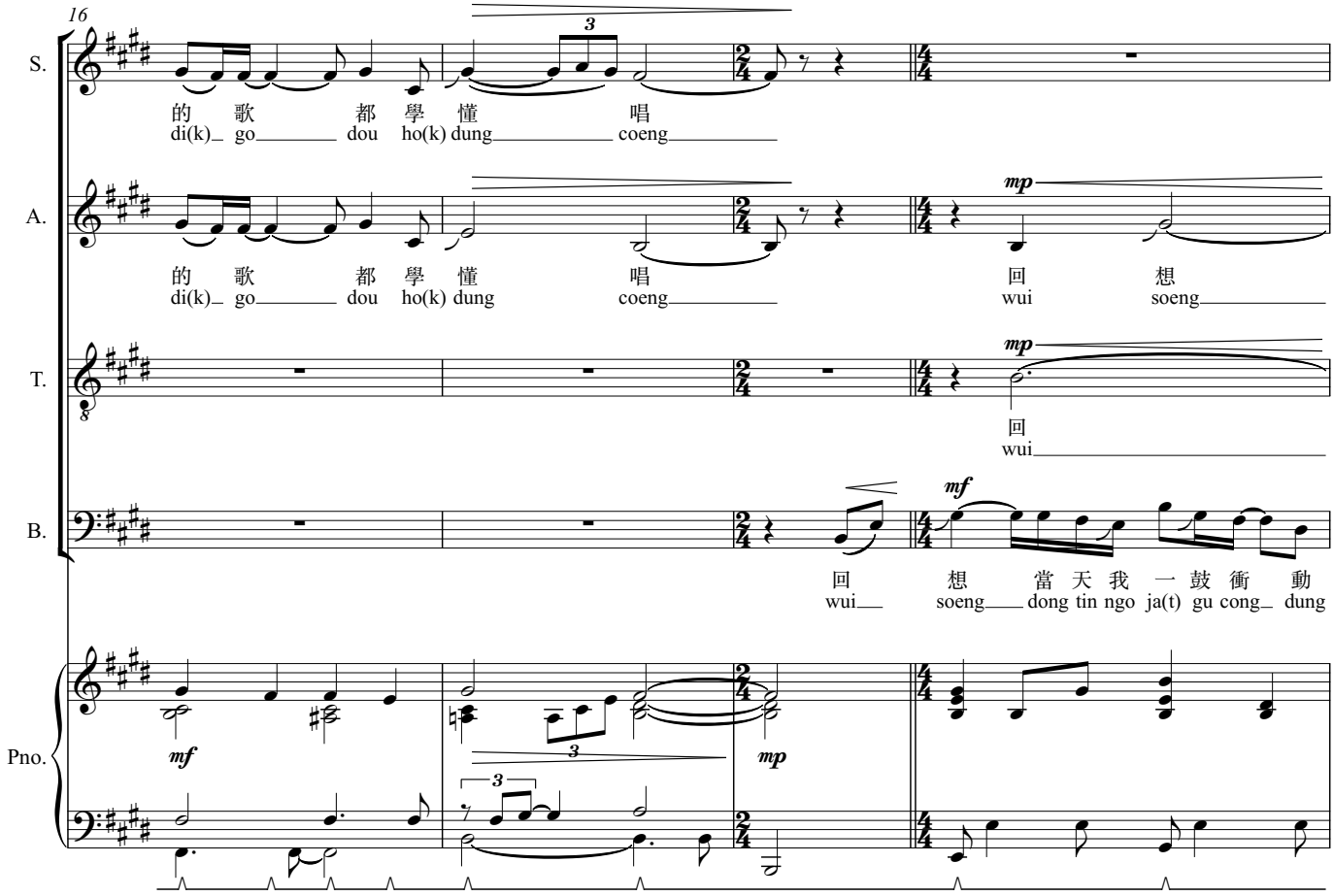


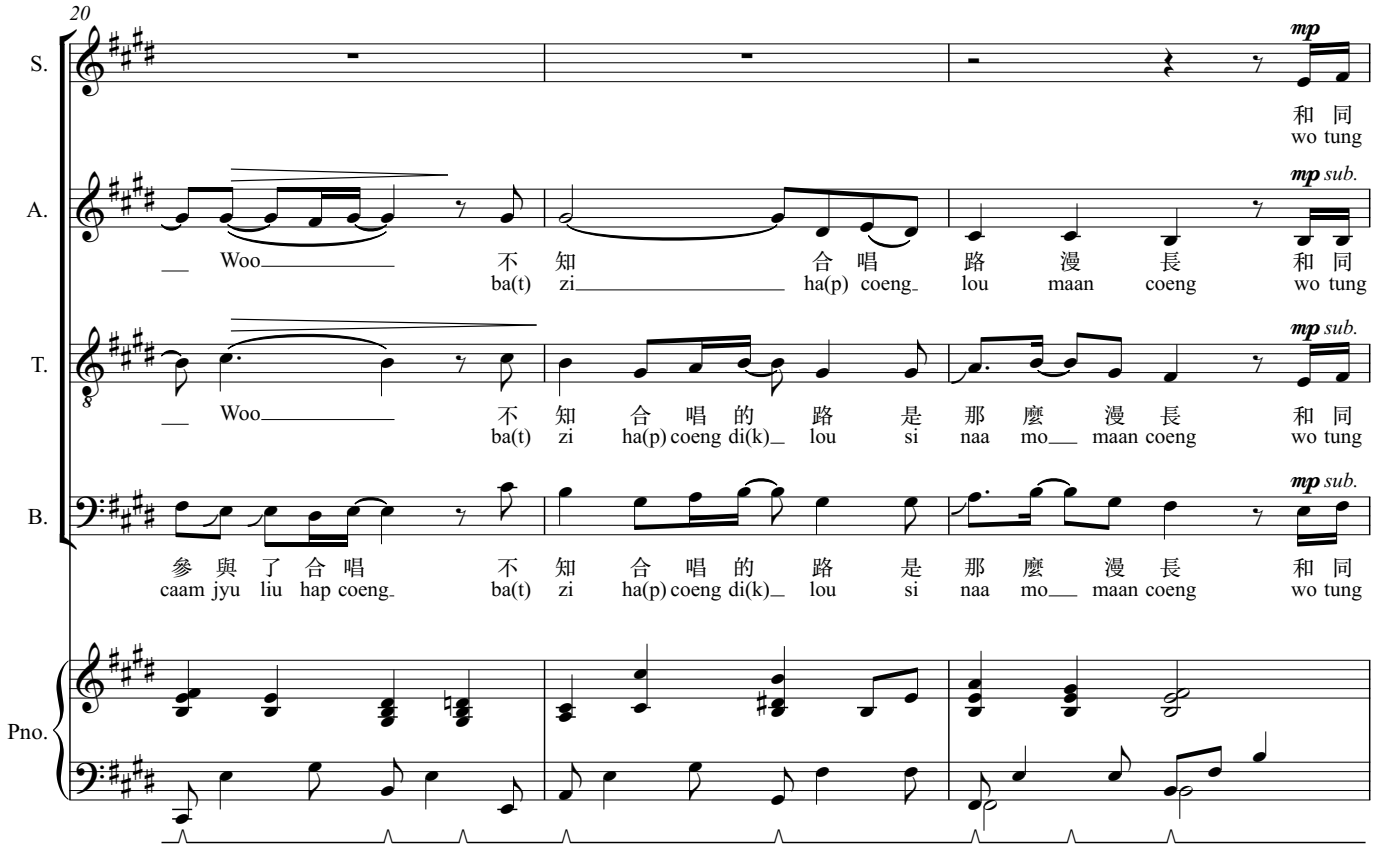
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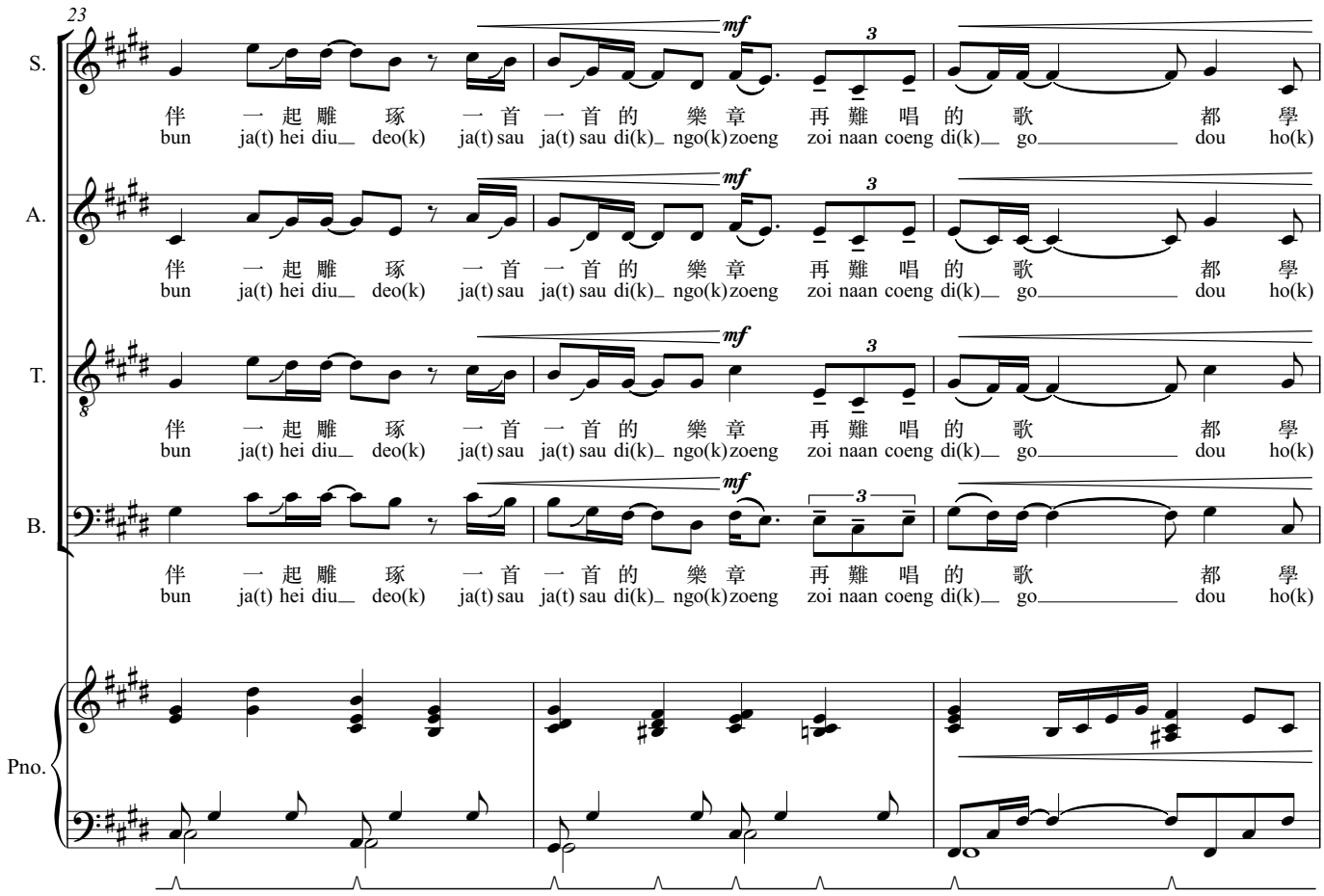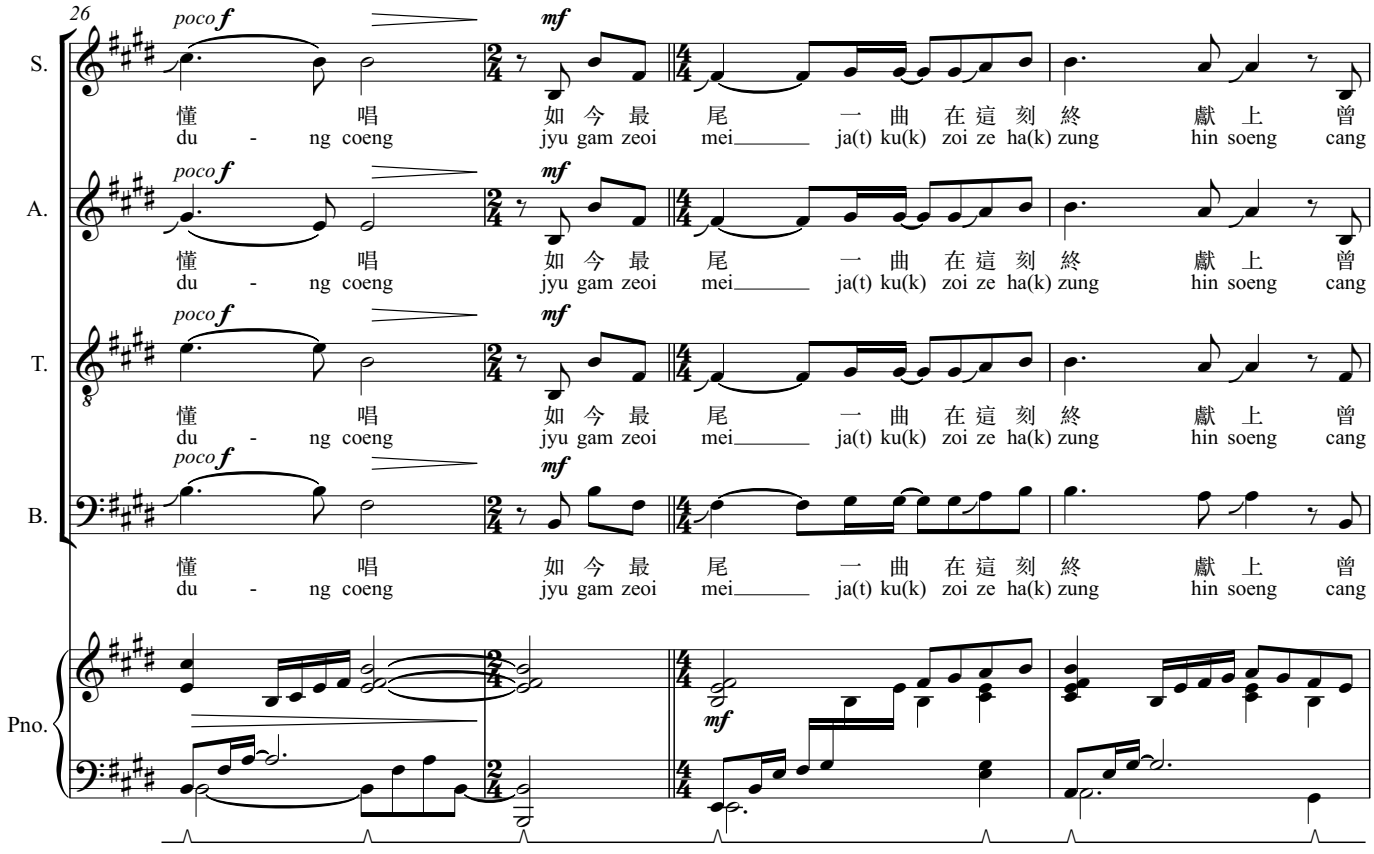




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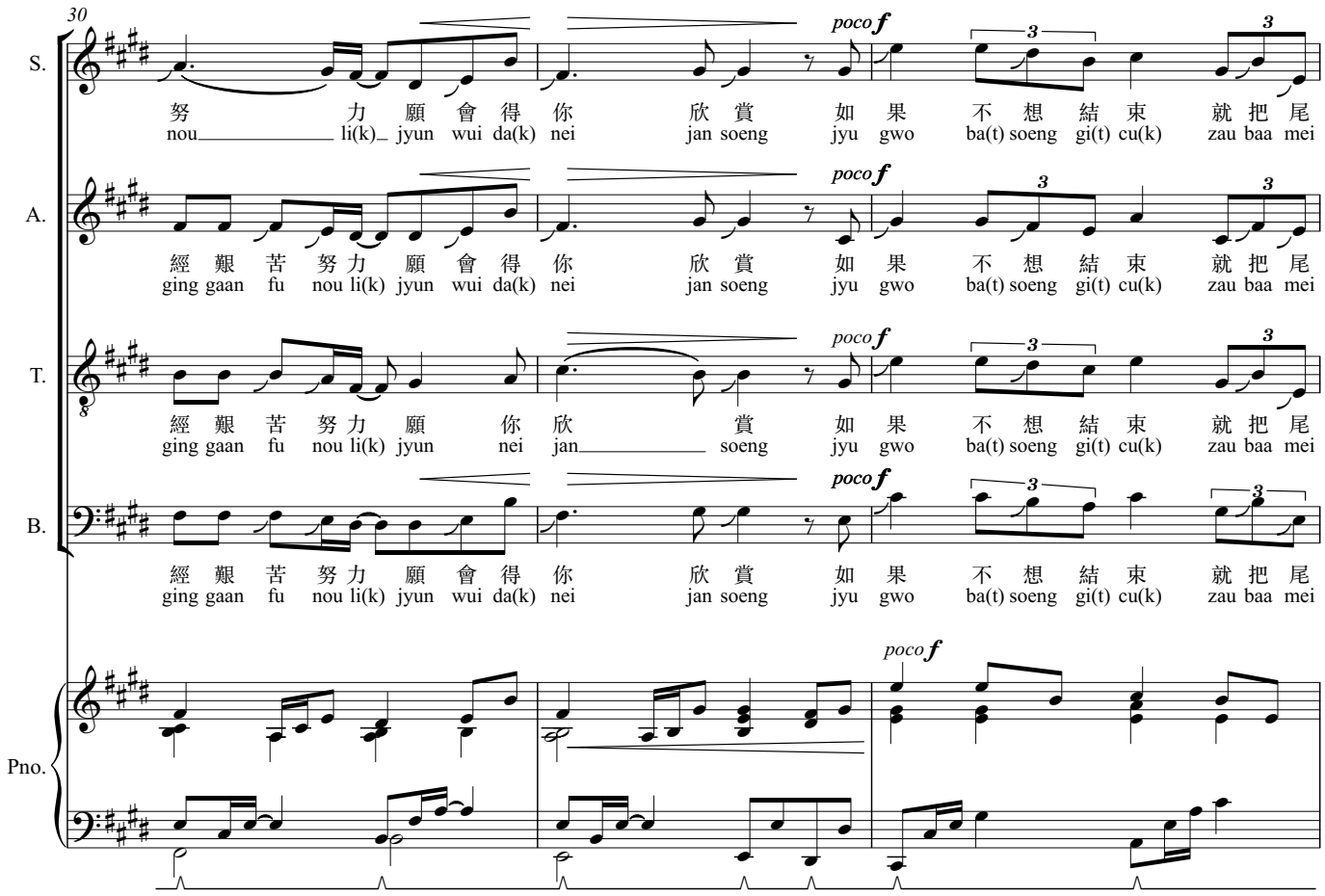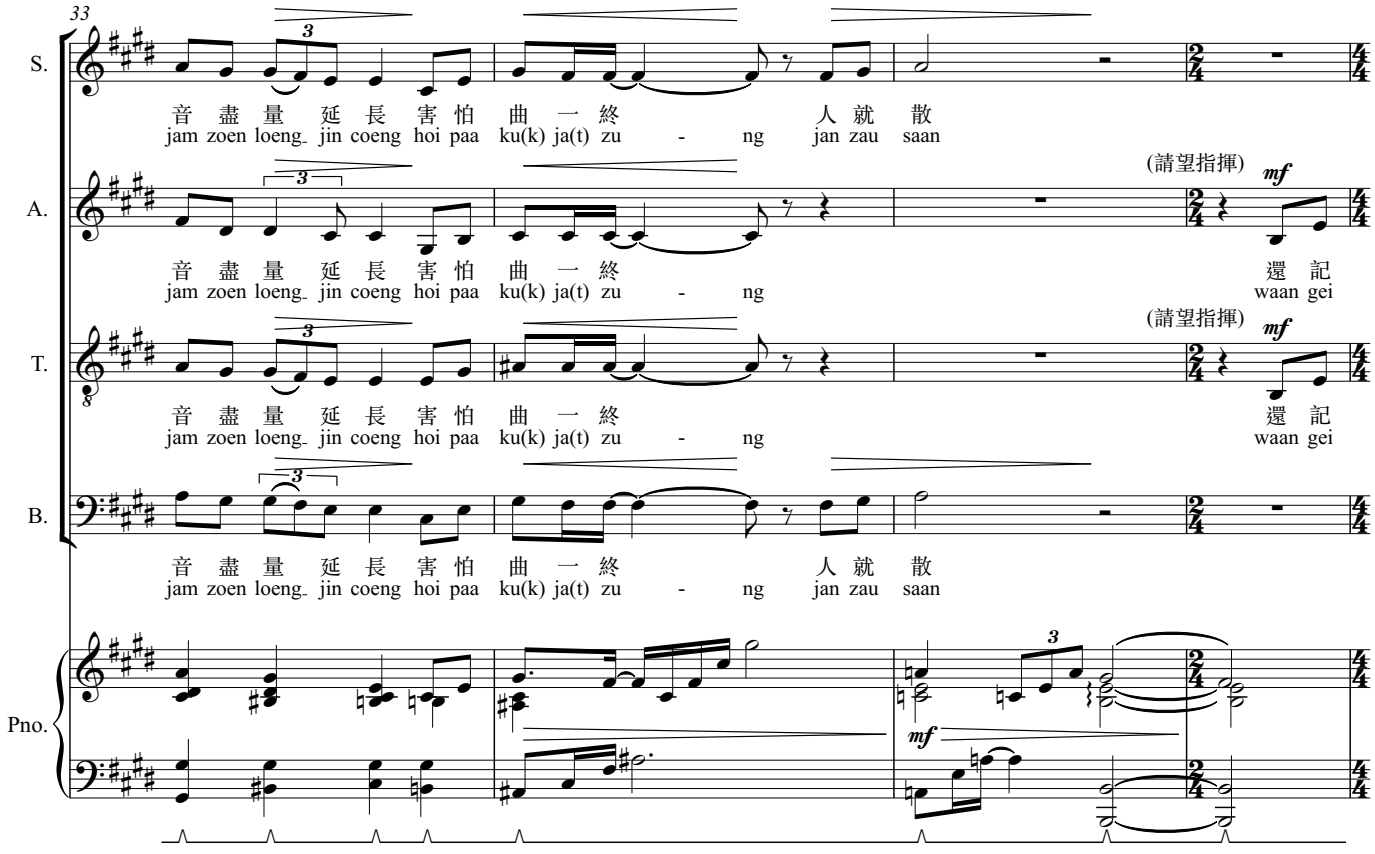




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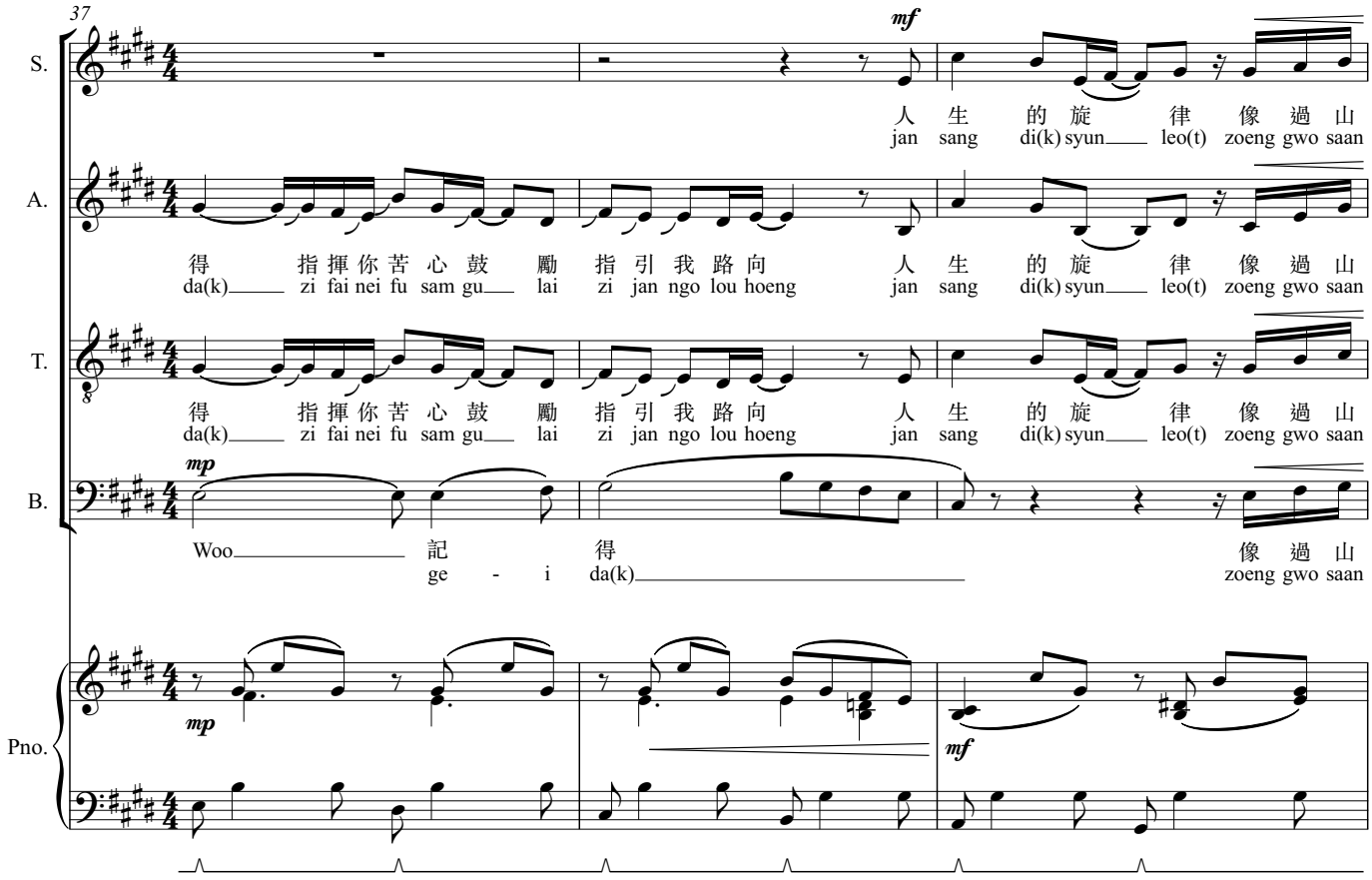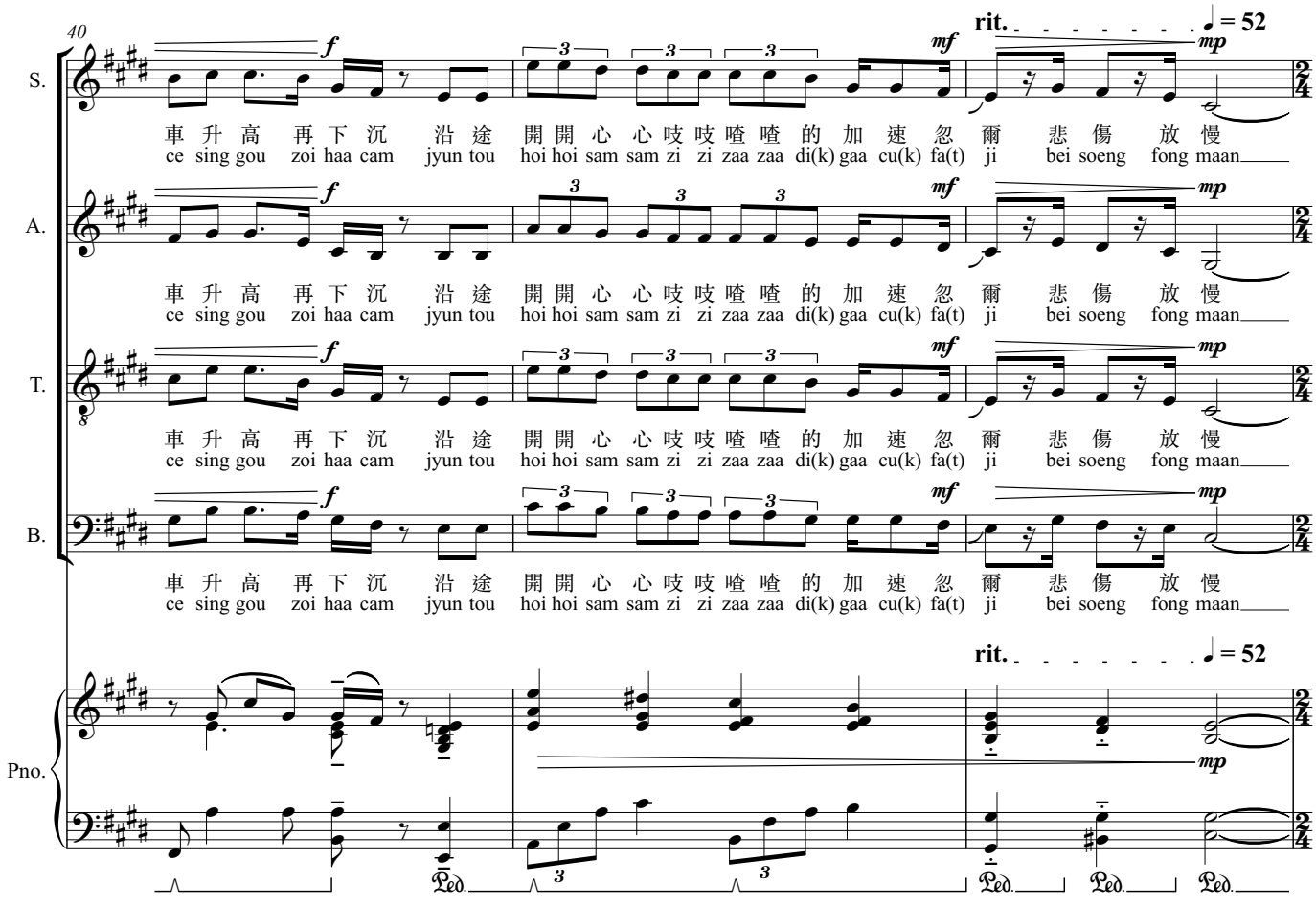




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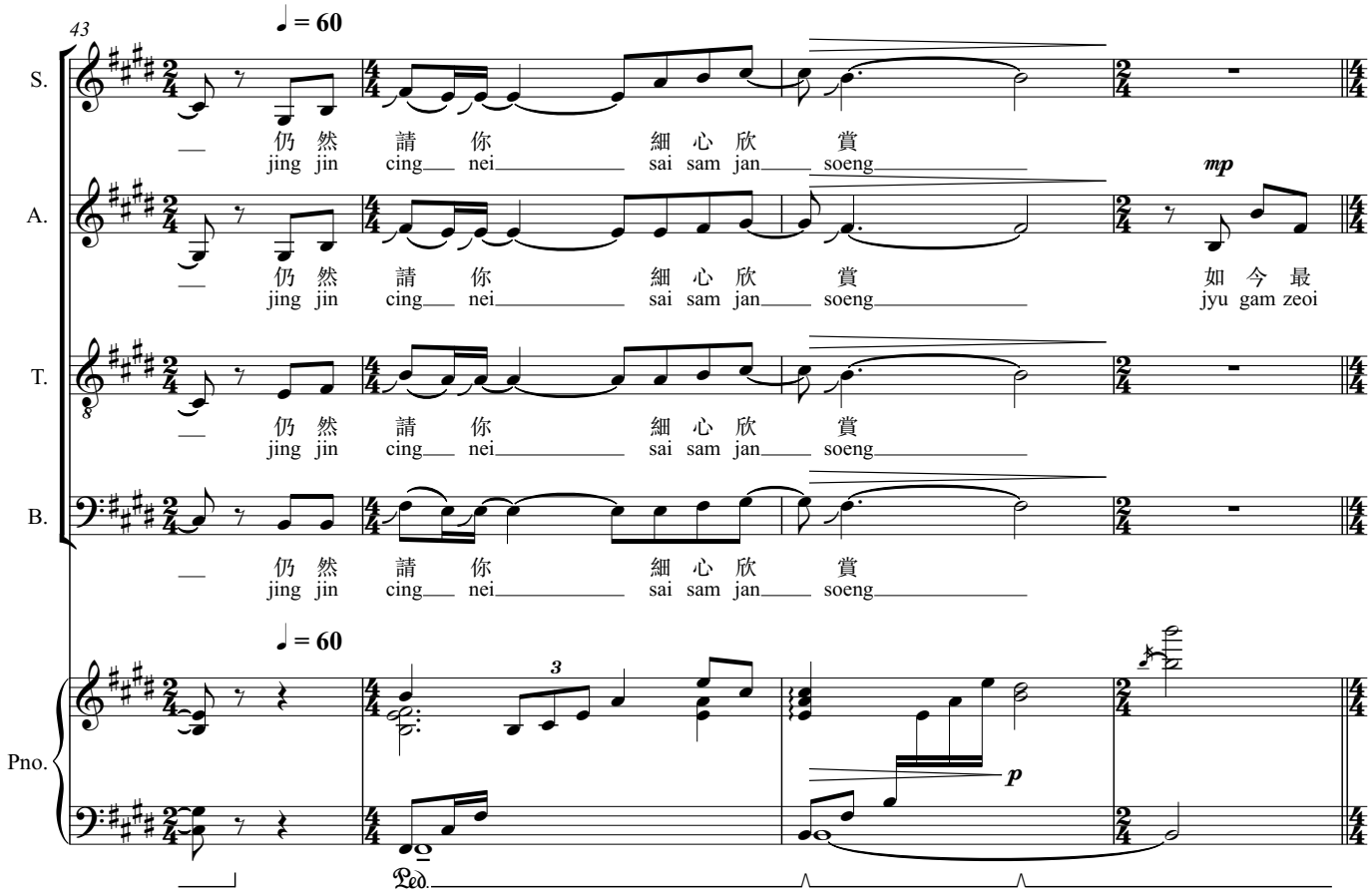




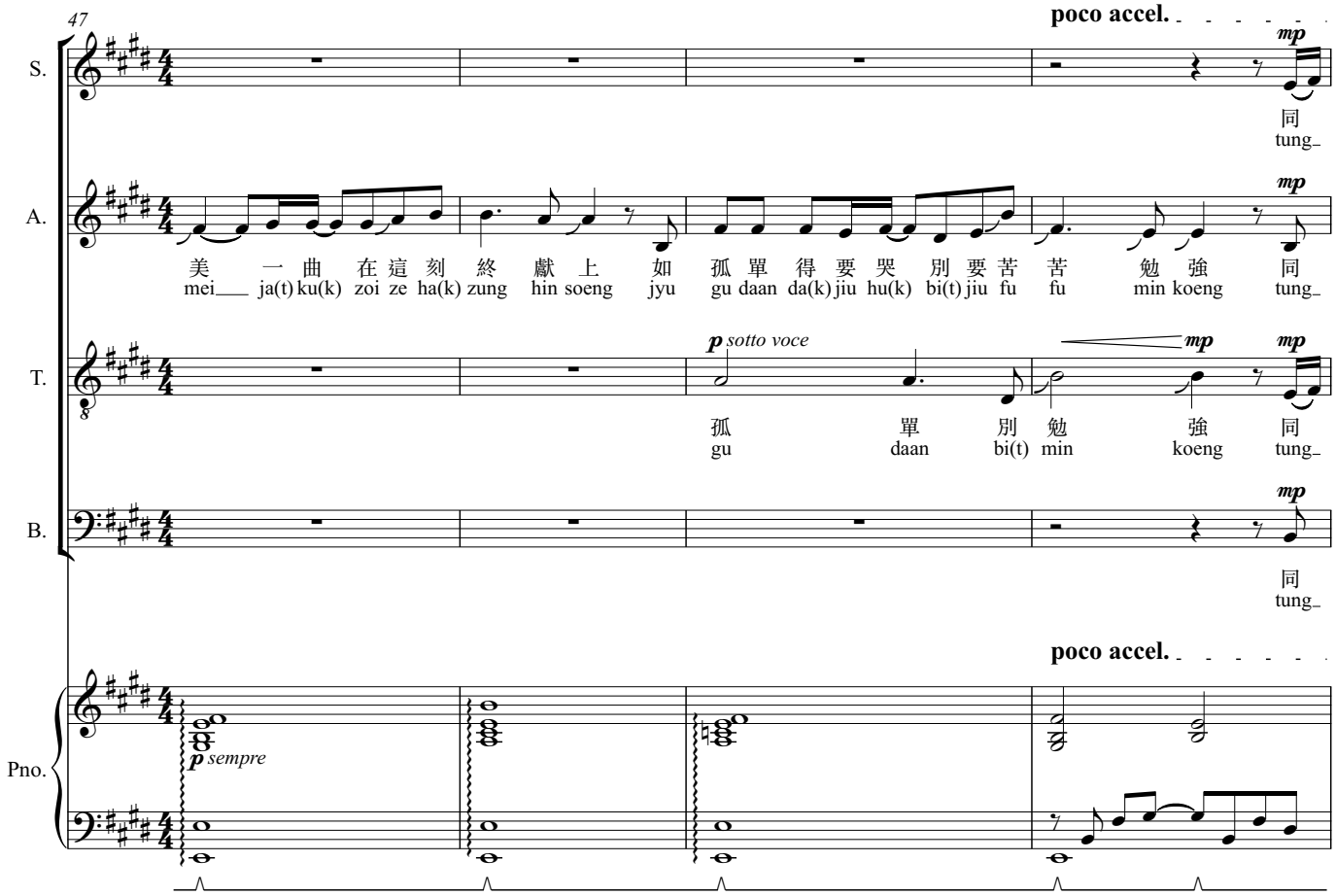
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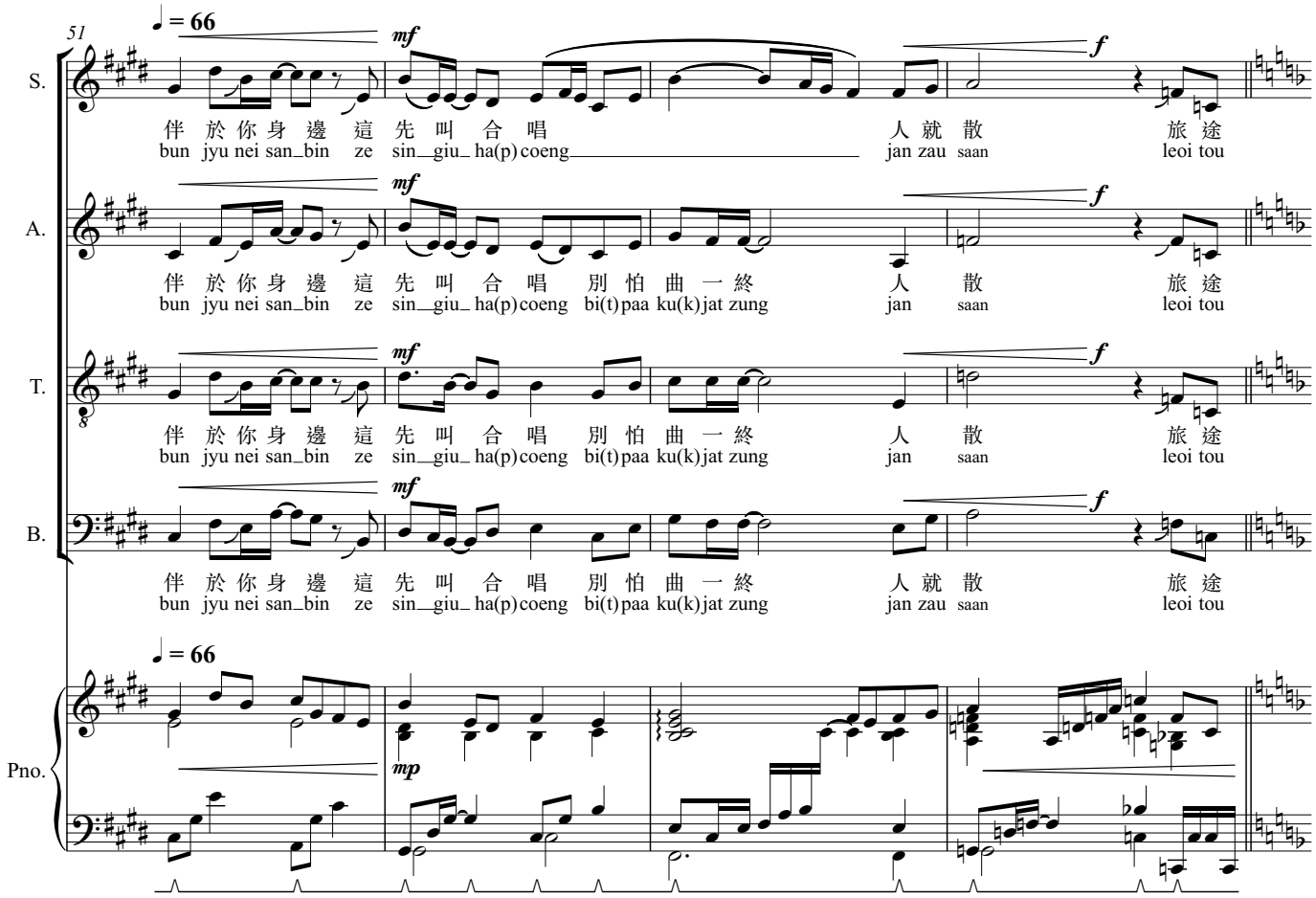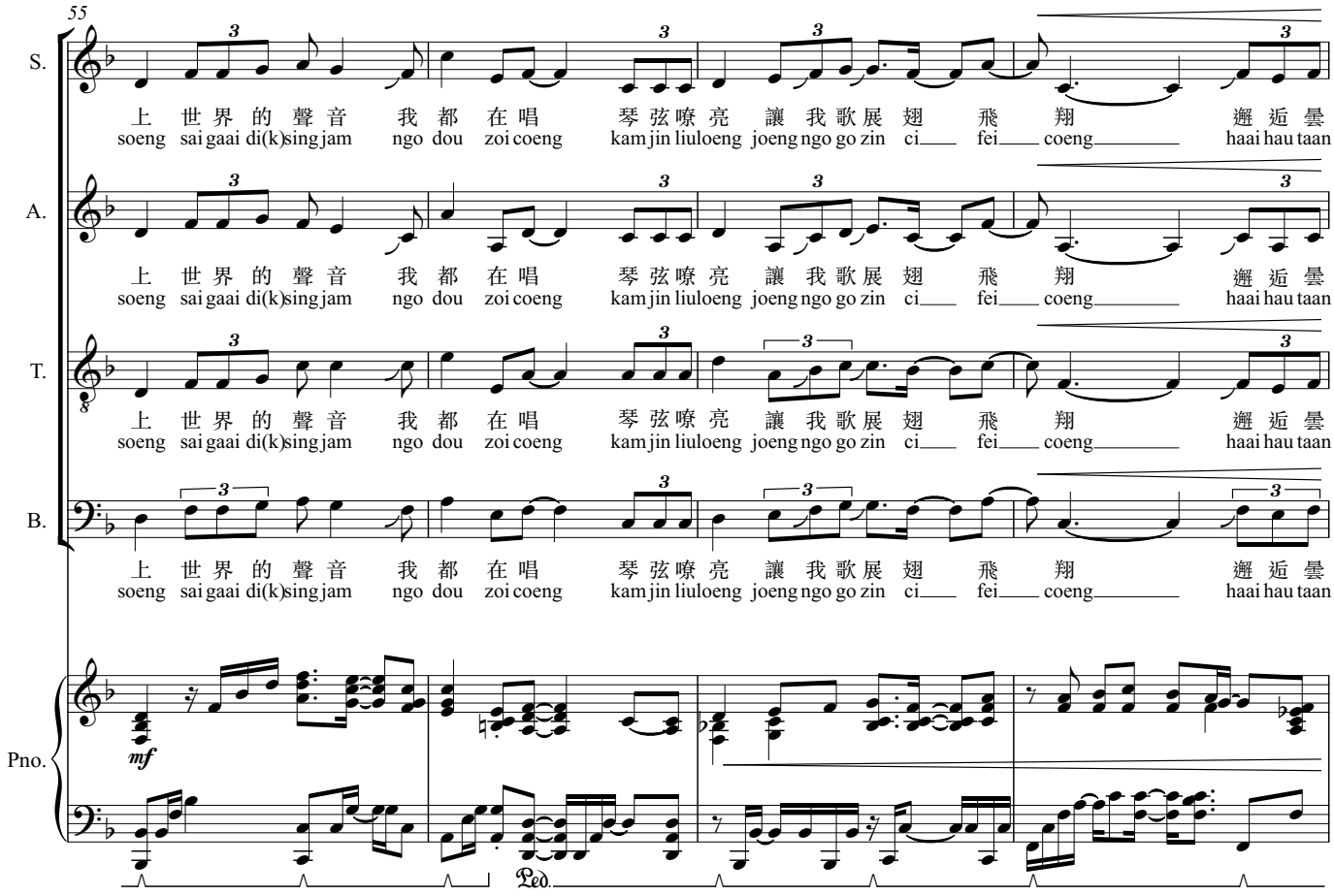




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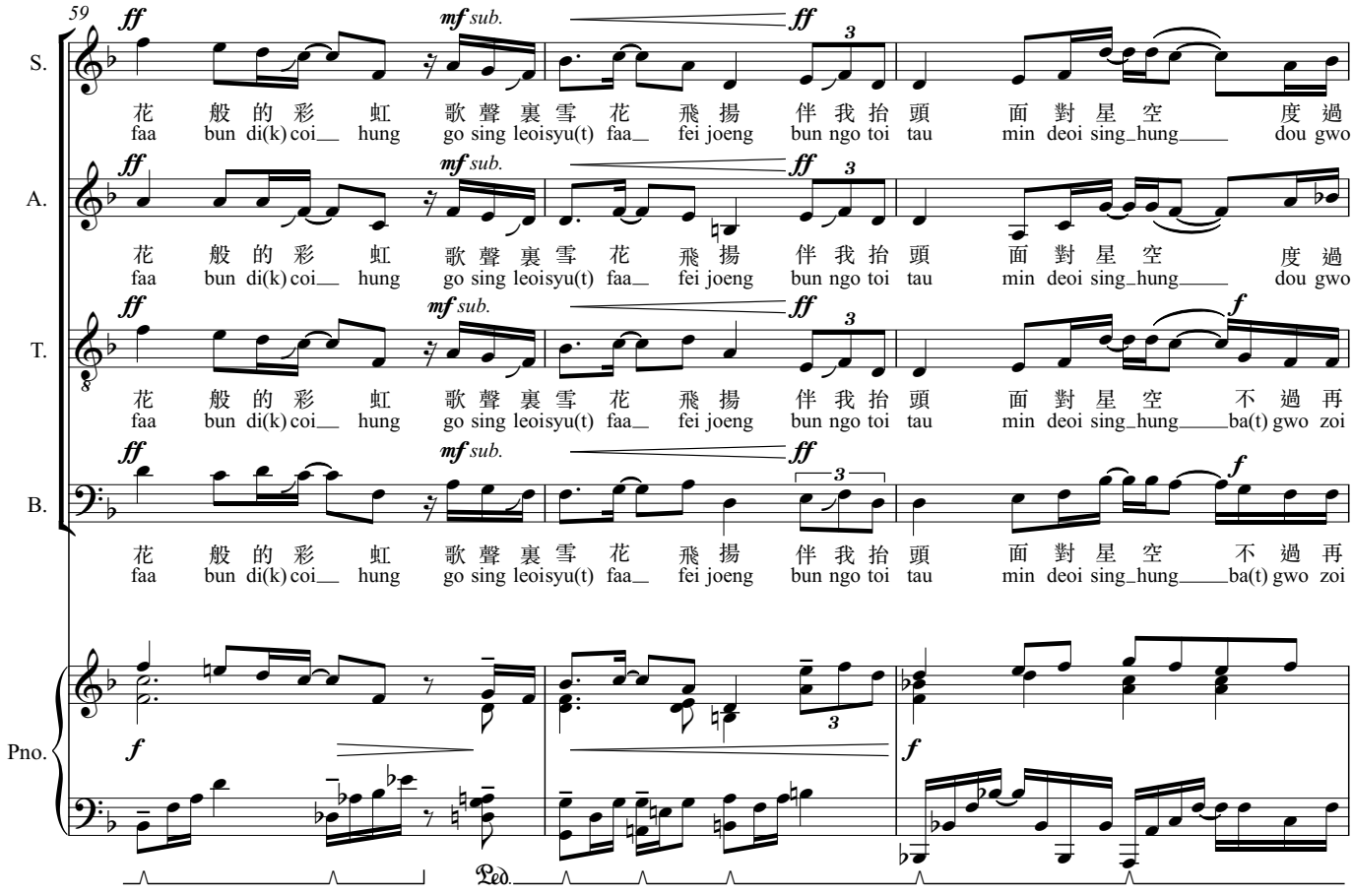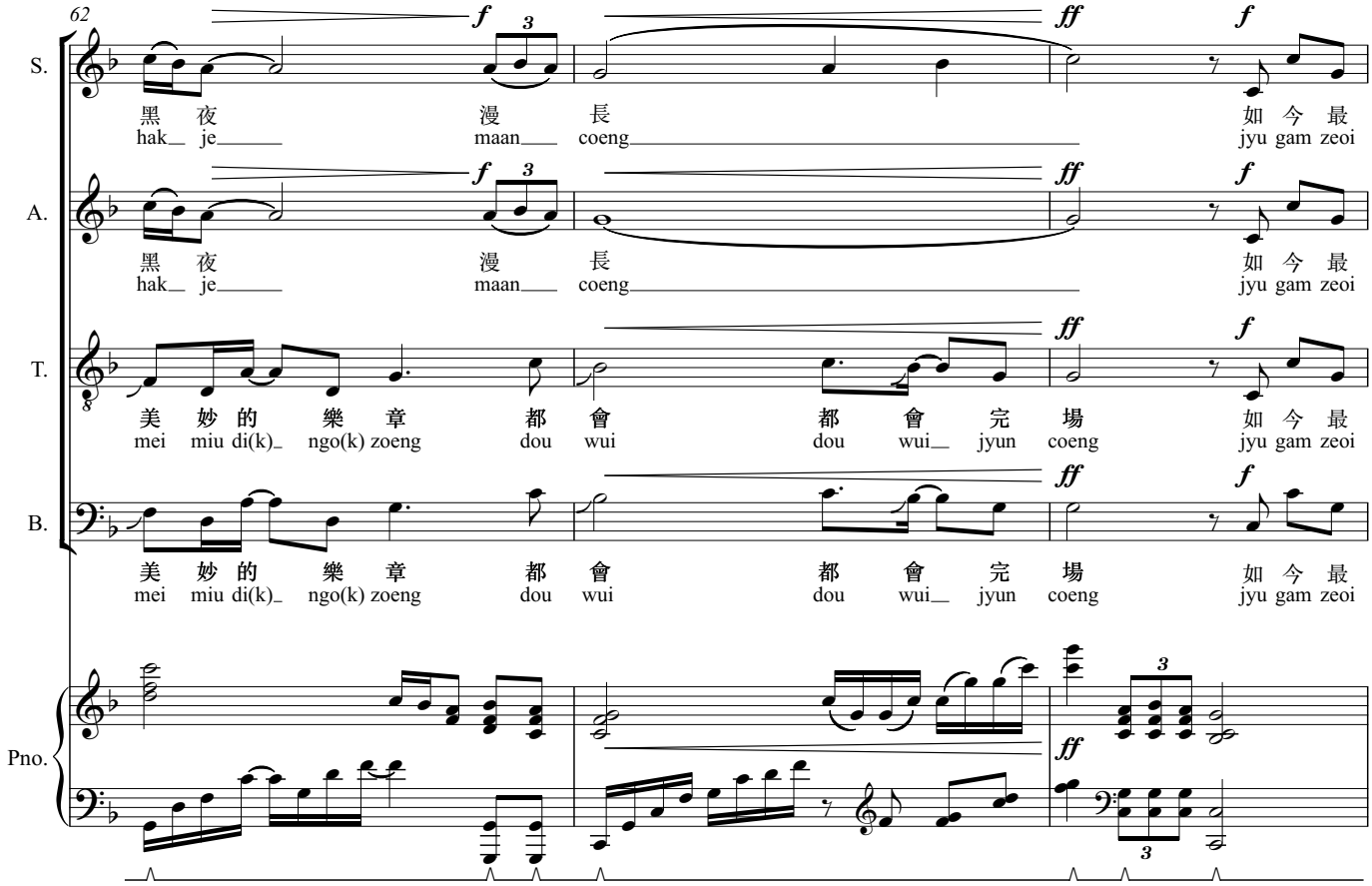




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optional choreography for youth/children choirs:
gradually walk to the front of stage
(possibly with gestures such as holding hands)
complete by bar. 71

(! different rhythm)

65

S. 美 一 曲 共 你 一 起 獻 上 如 開 心 得 要 哭 別 怕 哭
mei ja(t) ku(k) gung nei ja(t) hei hin soeng jyu hoi sam da(k) jiu hu(k) bi(t) paa hu(k)

A. 美 一 曲 共 你 一 起 獻 上 如 開 心 得 要 哭 別 怕 哭
mei ja(t) ku(k) gung nei ja(t) hei hin soeng jyu hoi sam da(k) jiu hu(k) bi(t) paa hu(k)

T. 美 一 曲 共 你 一 起 獻 上 如 開 心 得 要 哭 別 怕 哭
mei ja(t) ku(k) gung nei ja(t) hei hin soeng jyu hoi sam da(k) jiu hu(k) bi(t) paa hu(k)

B. 美 一 曲 共 你 一 起 獻 上 如 開 心 得 要 哭 別 怕 哭
mei ja(t) ku(k) gung nei ja(t) hei hin soeng jyu hoi sam da(k) jiu hu(k) bi(t) paa hu(k)

Pno.

68

S. 出 洋 相 如 果 不 想 結 束 相 約 下
ceo(t) joeng soeng jyu gwo ba(t) soeng gi(t) cu(k) soeng joe(k) haa
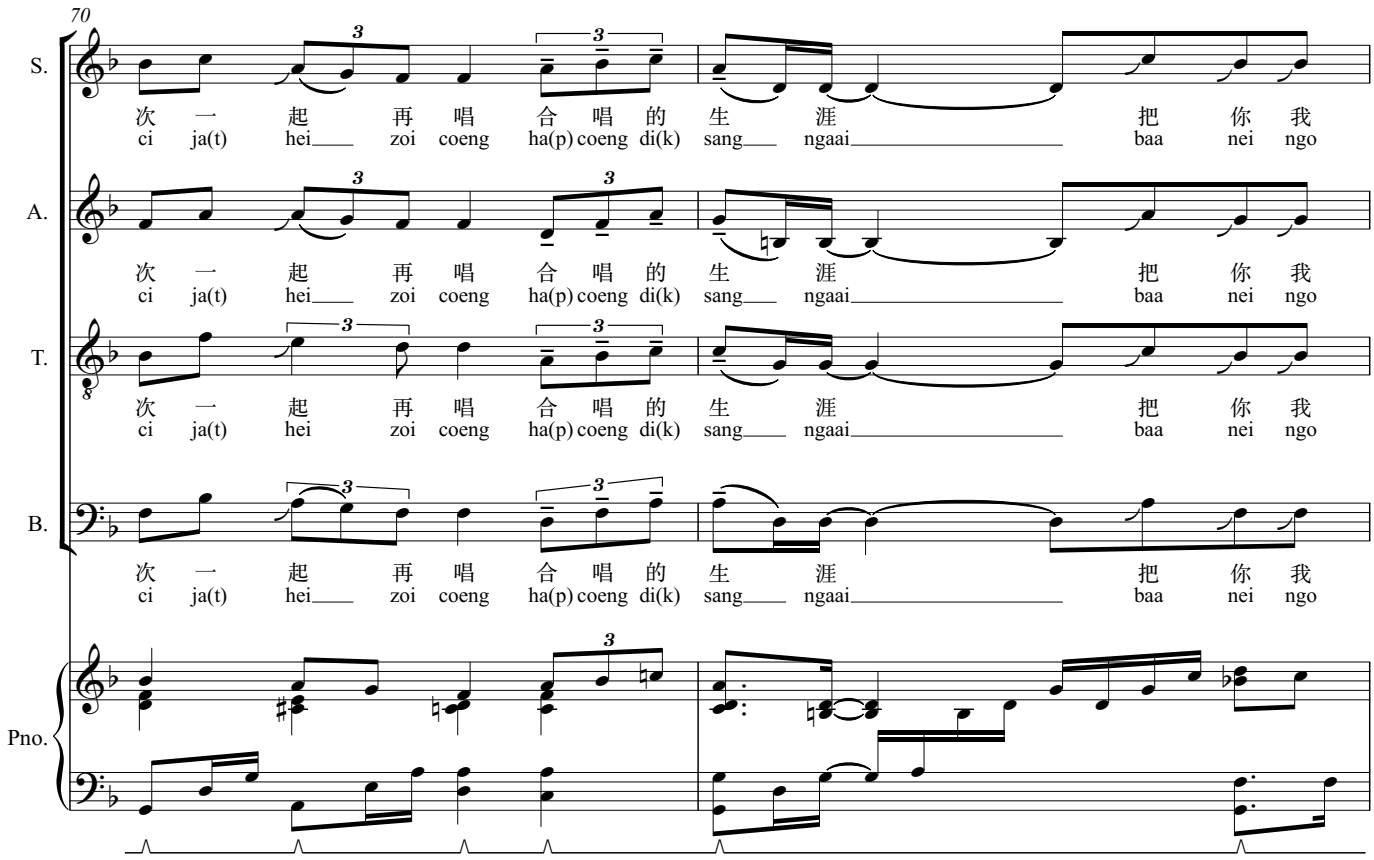
A. 出 洋 相 如 果 不 想 結 束 相 約 下
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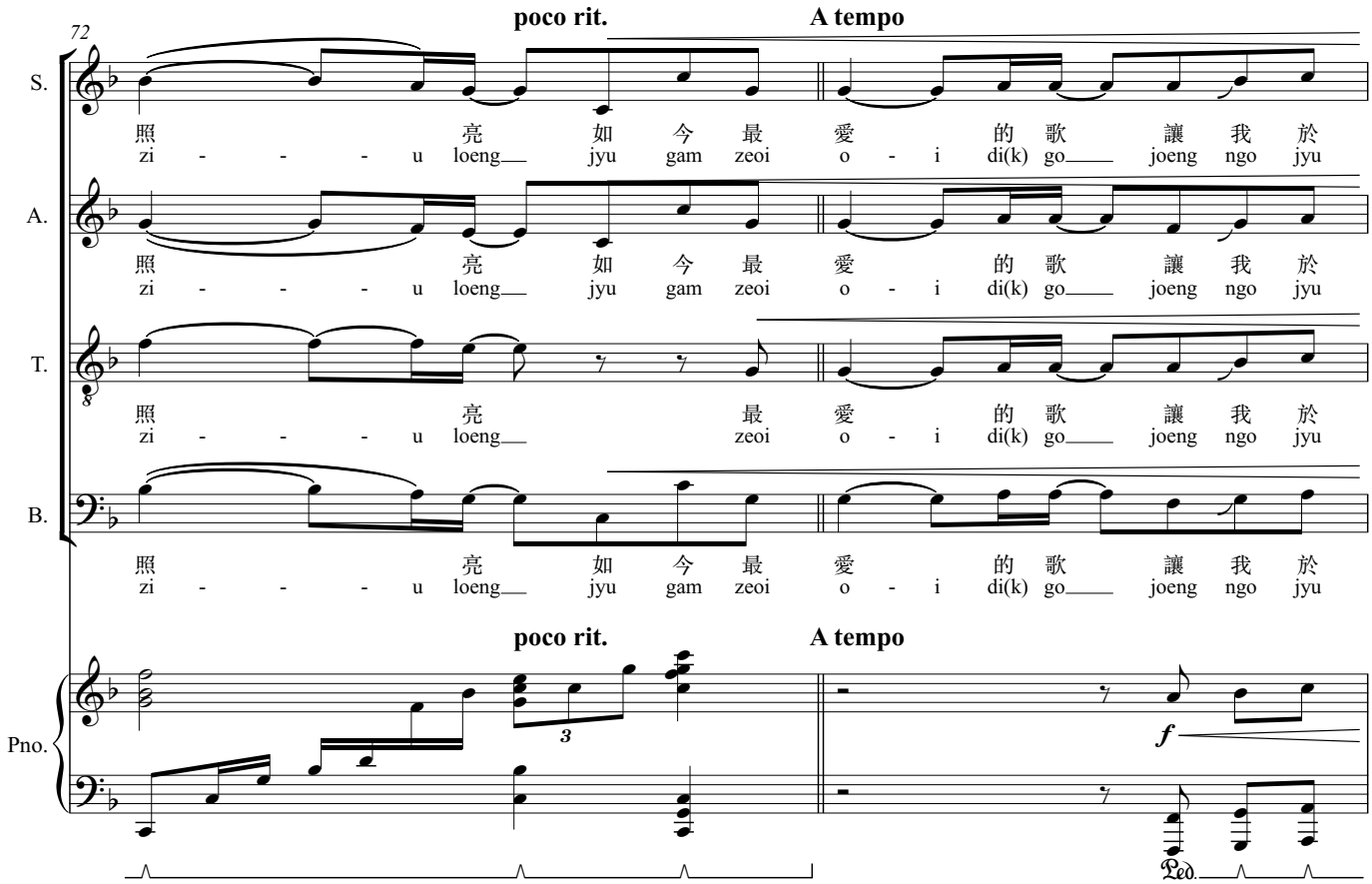
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B. 出 洋 相 如 果 不 想 結 束 相 約 下
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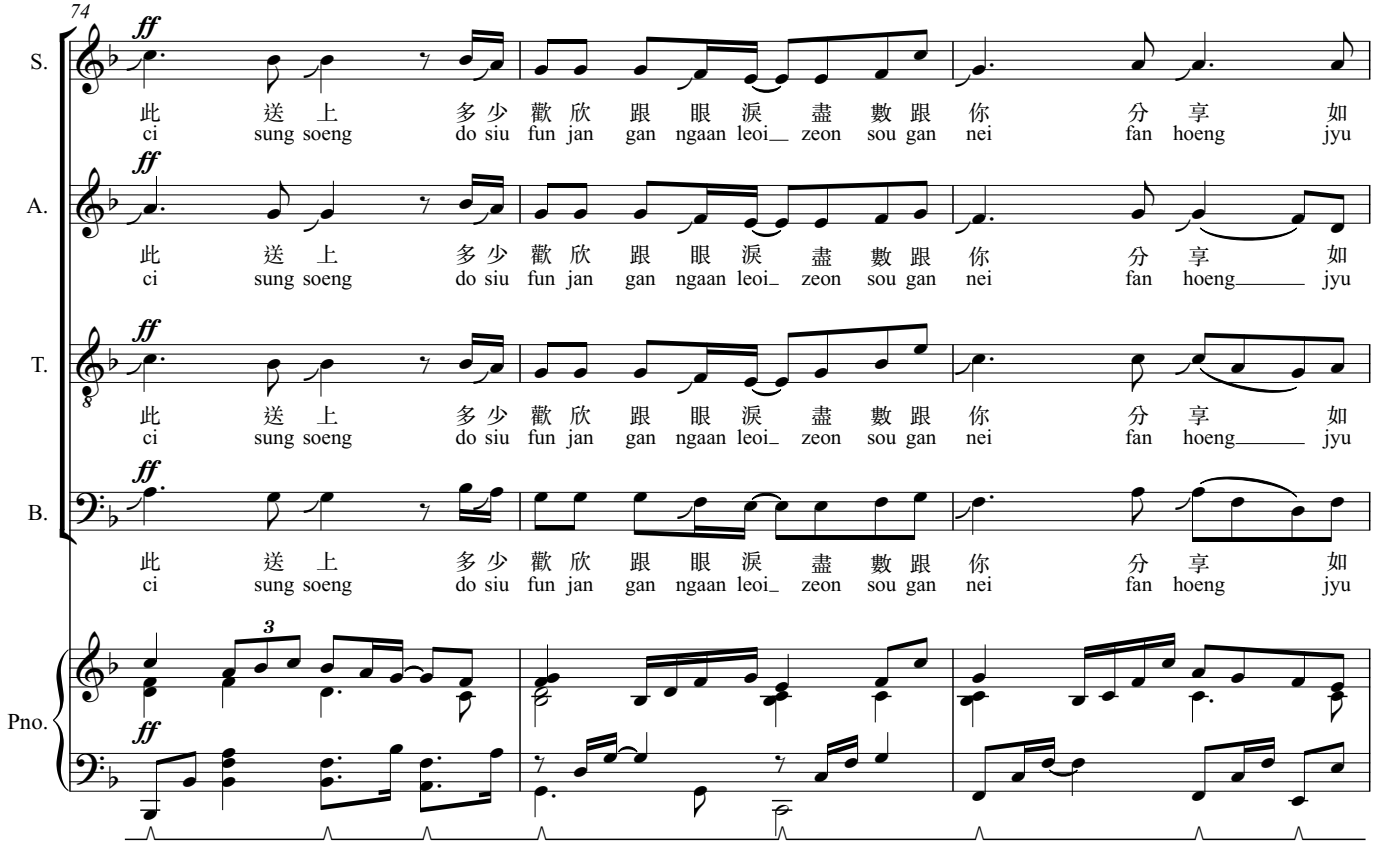
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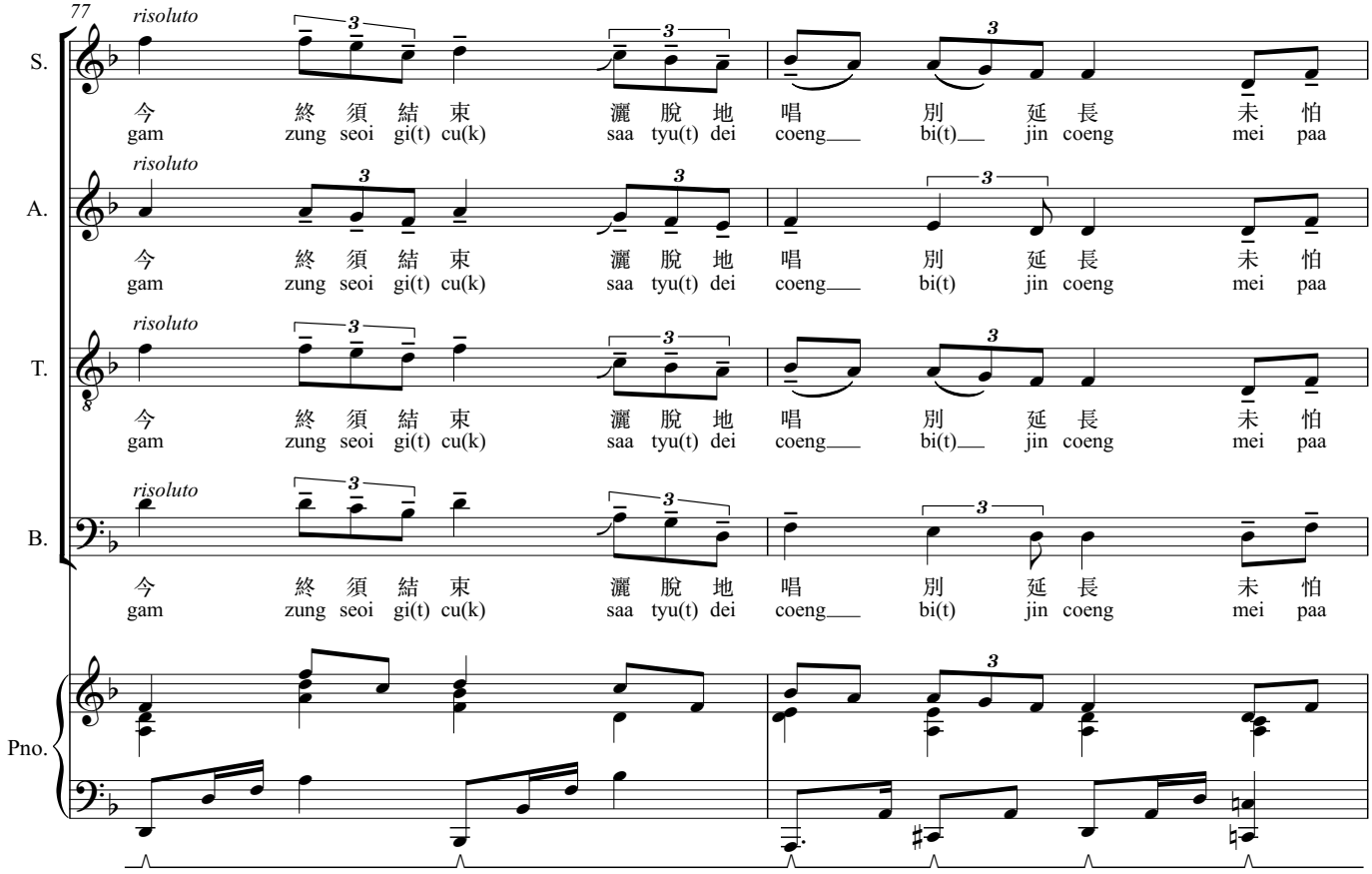
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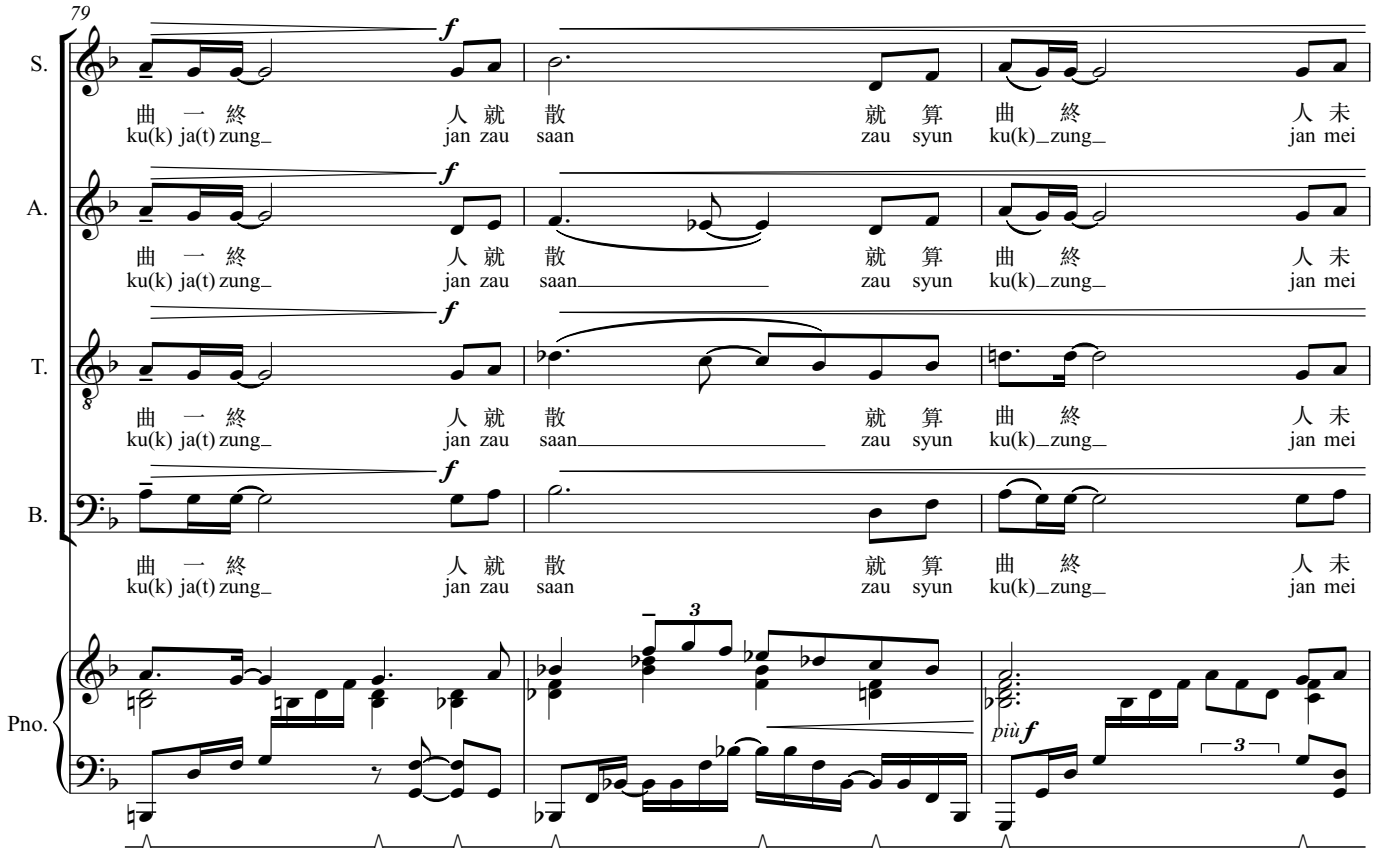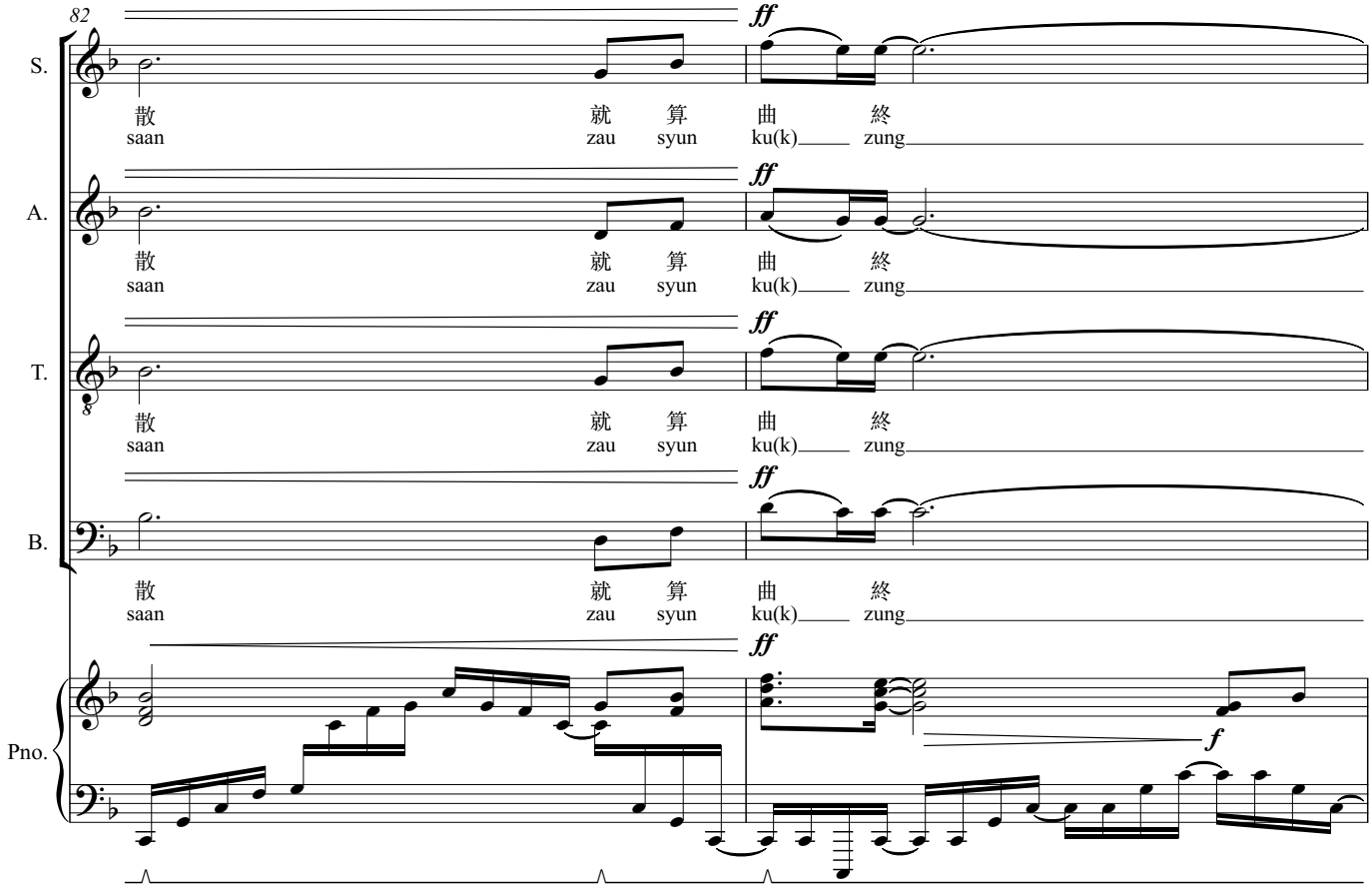


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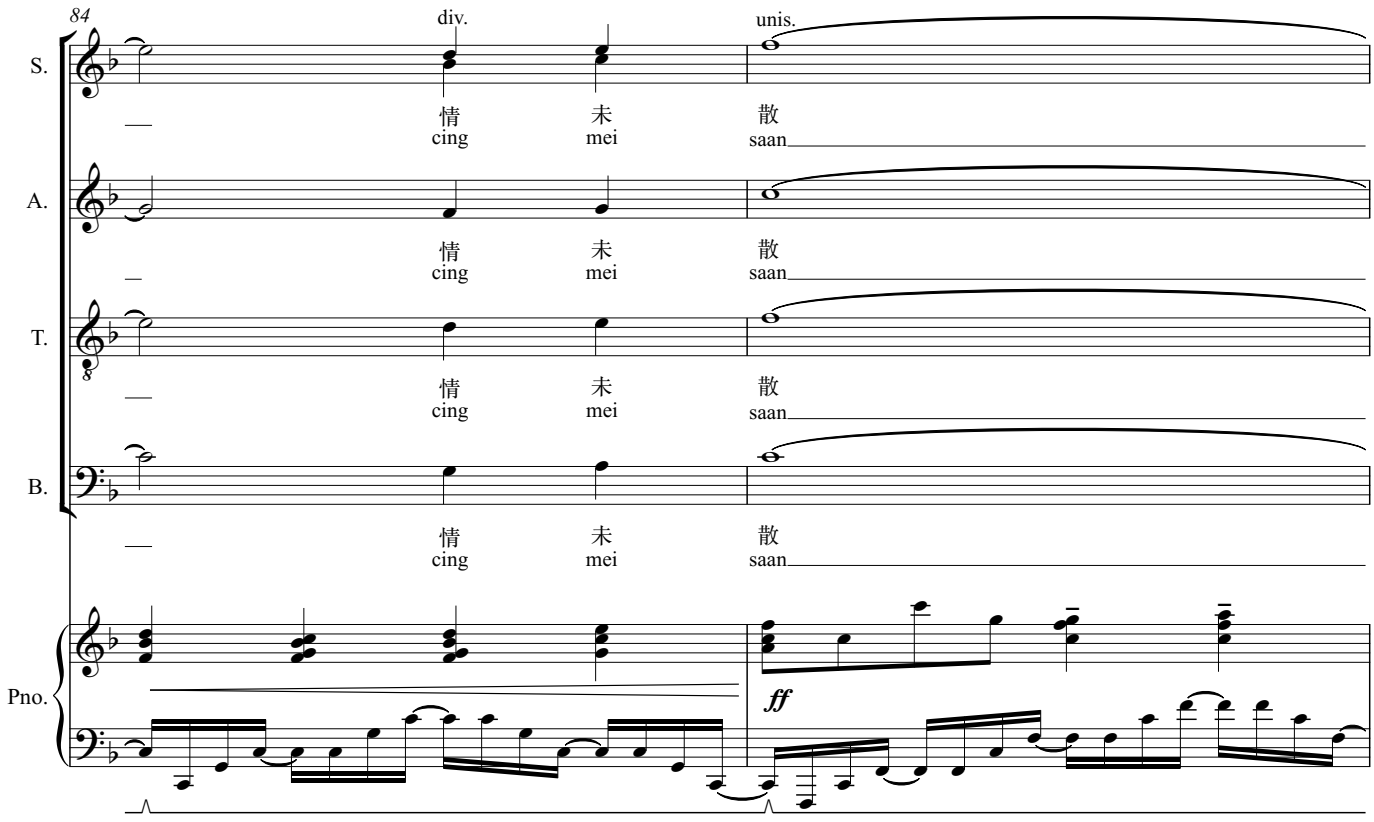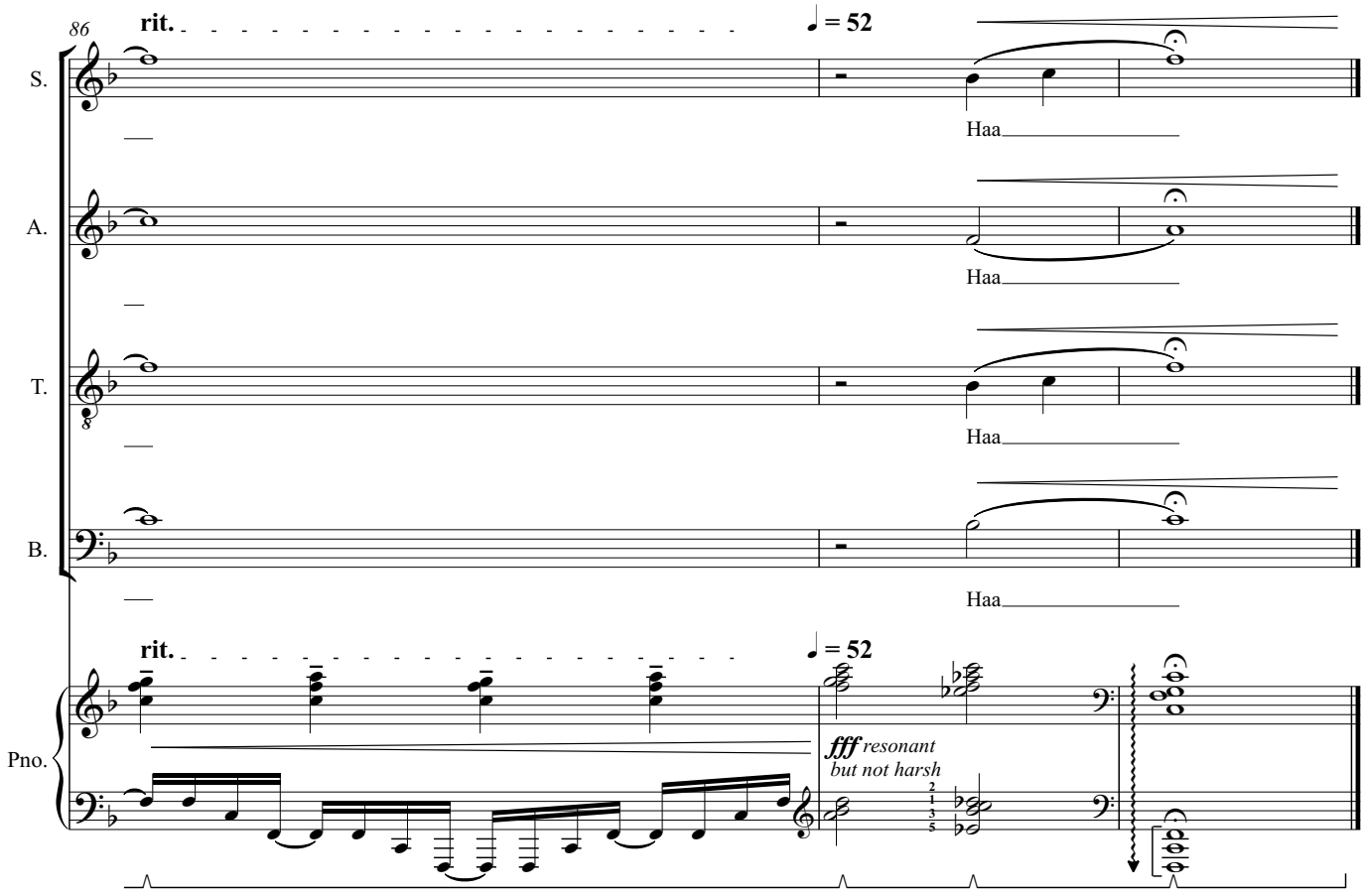




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